

Global Climate Events

Economic Impact

Data Dictionary | 2020 – 2025

2,929

Climate Events

20

Columns

50

Countries

6

Year Span

This document explains every column in the global climate events dataset. Each entry covers what the column means in plain language, its data type, valid range, and example values — so anyone can understand the data without prior technical knowledge.

COLUMN TYPE GUIDE

- ID
- Date
- Text
- Number
- Geography
- Calculated

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1 Identification & Timing

event_id

ID

A unique code that identifies each climate event. No two rows share the same ID.

Format Text code starting with "EV" + 5 digits

Example EV01539, EV02303

date

Date

The exact calendar date when the event began.

Format YYYY-MM-DD (year-month-day)

Example 2020-01-01

year

Number

The year in which the event occurred. Useful for year-over-year trend analysis.

Range 2020 – 2025

Example 2022

month

Number

The month the event started, stored as a number. Enables seasonal analysis (e.g. are floods more common in summer?).

Range 1 (January) – 12 (December)

Example 7 = July

2 Location

country

Text

The name of the country where the event took place.

Unique values 50 countries

Example Japan, Canada, Brazil, Australia

latitude

Geography

The north-south position on the globe. Combined with longitude, it pinpoints where the event happened on a map. Positive values = North, negative = South.

Range -89.76 (far south) to +89.98 (far north)

Example 35.71 = northern Japan

longitude

Geography

The east-west position on the globe. Used together with latitude to place the event on a map. Positive = East, negative = West.

Range -180 (far west) to +180 (far east)

Example 138.72 = central Japan

3 Event Characteristics

event_type

Text

The category of climate or natural disaster that occurred.

12 possible values Cold Wave, Drought, Earthquake, Flood, Hailstorm, Heatwave, Hurricane, Landslide, Tornado, Tsunami, Volcanic Eruption, Wildfire

severity

Number

A score rating how destructive and dangerous the event was. Higher numbers indicate more severe events.

Scale 1 (minor) to 9 (catastrophic)

Example 3 = moderate impact, 8 = very severe

duration_days

Number

How many days the event lasted from start to end.

Unit Days

Range 0 – 115 days

Example 6 = lasted 6 days

4 Human Impact

affected_population

Number

The total number of people whose daily lives were disrupted — including those evacuated, displaced, or cut off from basic services.

Unit Number of people

Range 622 – 56,248,325 people

Example 420,956

deaths

Number

The number of people who died as a direct result of the event.

Unit Number of people

Range 0 – 117 deaths

injuries

Number

The number of people physically injured (but surviving) during the event.

Unit Number of people

Range 0 – 734 injuries

total_casualties

Calculated

Deaths and injuries combined into one figure, giving a quick snapshot of overall human harm caused by the event.

Formula deaths + injuries

Range 0 – 738

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Economic Impact

economic_impact_million_usd

Number

The total financial damage caused by the event — covering destroyed property, lost businesses, and clean-up costs — measured in millions of US dollars.

Unit	Millions of USD (e.g. 5.0 = USD 5 million)
Range	USD 0 – USD 718.21 million
Median	USD 0.09 million (most events are small-scale)

infrastructure_damage_score

Number

A composite score measuring how badly the event damaged physical infrastructure such as roads, bridges, buildings, and power lines. Higher means more destruction.

Range	0.2 – 63.0 (higher = worse)
Example	8.9 = significant damage

impact_per_capita

Calculated

Economic damage divided by the number of people affected. Normalises the financial impact so that small localised events can be compared fairly with large-scale ones.

Formula	$\text{economic_impact_million_usd} / \text{affected_population}$
Range	USD 0 – USD 181.62 per person

6

Response & Aid

response_time_hours

Number

How many hours elapsed before emergency responders arrived and began helping. A lower value means a faster, more effective response.

Unit	Hours
Range	0 – 60 hours
Example	11 = responders arrived within 11 hours

international_aid_million_usd

Number

The amount of financial assistance received from other countries or international organisations to deal with the event.

Unit	Millions of USD
Range	USD 0 – USD 164.51 million
Note	Many events received USD 0 (handled domestically)

aid_percentage

Calculated

The share of total economic damage that was covered by international aid. Expressed as a percentage.

Formula	$\text{international_aid} / \text{economic_impact} \times 100$
Unit	Percentage (%)
Range	0% – 22.9%
Example	15 = 15% of damage was covered by external aid

Column type legend

ID	Unique identifier — one value per row
Date	Date or time value
Text	Category or free-text label
Number	Raw measured or counted value
Geography	Map coordinate (latitude or longitude)
Calculated	Derived from other columns in the dataset